

SIMON KUESTER

Cybersecurity Engineer | Threat Detection, Security Automation & NIST/CMMC Compliance
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EDUCATION

University of North Georgia

Bachelor of Science in Cybersecurity

GPA: 3.84 / 4.0 | Dean's / President's List (2022–2025)

Relevant Coursework: Network Security, Operating Systems, Applied Cybersecurity, Script Programming

Dahlonega, GA

Graduated November 2025

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ (Jan 2026) | CompTIA A+ (Aug 2025) | StrongDM Deployment Expert (Mar 2026)

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Associate – Genix Cyber

Mar 2026 – Present

- Built 75+ MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules and active-response automation for high-risk privileged events spanning command execution, credential access, persistence, and defense evasion
- Mapped detection, audit-logging, and privileged-access capabilities to NIST SP 800-171 and CMMC Level 2 control families (Access Control, Audit & Accountability, Incident Response, System & Information Integrity), supporting client gap/readiness assessments and compliance reporting
- Engineered a StrongDM-to-Argus XDR (Wazuh-based) integration that ingests JSON gateway audit logs and maps privileged actions to authenticated users for shared-account attribution across 3 client tenants, strengthening Access Control (AC) and Audit & Accountability (AU) coverage
- Integrated pfSense firewall telemetry into Argus XDR, developing custom decoders and correlation rules that enabled detection of failed VPN logins, administrative access attempts, and off-hours activity across a client environment
- Developed an automated ticketing integration that opens a DFIR-IRIS case for every Level 12+ alert — pre-enriched with rule, agent, MITRE, and full-log context — eliminating manual ticket creation and accelerating triage and incident-response documentation
- Serve as technical partner manager for StrongDM, Genix Cyber's privileged access management (PAM) partner, owning the relationship and translating partner integration requirements into Argus XDR detection use cases

Cybersecurity Engineering Intern – Genix Cyber

Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Developed and validated 30 detection use cases across 10 MITRE ATT&CK techniques, covering brute force, persistence, anomalous process execution, and suspicious Linux/Windows telemetry
- Built a centralized file-analysis and automated malware-response workflow combining File Integrity Monitoring, VirusTotal enrichment, and 30+ custom YARA rules, automatically removing malicious files within seconds of detection with no manual intervention
- Automated SIEM agent installation and configuration with Bash and Windows Batch, cutting manual setup time by ~70%
- Tuned detections and reduced false positives by analyzing Linux syslog, Windows Event Logs, and application logs across multiple test environments

PROJECTS

AI-Driven Detection Engineering Platform

- Engineered an AI-driven detection-engineering workflow by extending a Model Context Protocol (MCP) server that connects Claude/LLMs to a Wazuh SIEM, adding custom tools for rule authoring and live validation to drive alert triage and rule tuning through natural language
- Validated detections against live adversary behavior using Atomic Red Team, emulating 16 MITRE ATT&CK techniques in an isolated Windows lab and closing coverage gaps through iterative rule tuning
- Reduced high/critical false positives by 90% on a Windows baseline by authoring scoped, least-impact suppression rules validated against true-positive samples, cutting analyst alert fatigue without sacrificing detection integrity

Behavior-Based Botnet Detection Framework

- Designed a multi-stage Wazuh detection framework that identifies polymorphic Golang botnet behavior through behavioral heuristics rather than static indicators
- Authored 20+ custom correlation rules (frequency/timeframe logic) to detect credential stuffing, brute force, webshell deployment, and packed binaries, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK techniques
- Validated across 50+ simulated attack events: zero false negatives over four attack stages and under 5% false positives at baseline

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Compliance & Frameworks: NIST CSF, NIST SP 800-53, NIST SP 800-171, CMMC, MITRE ATT&CK, TX-RAMP

Tools & Platforms: Wazuh / Argus XDR, StrongDM, Shuffle, DFIR-IRIS, YARA, VirusTotal, pfSense, Kali Linux

Scripting & Automation: Python, Bash, PowerShell, Windows Batch, REST APIs, MCP, Active Response

Security Operations & Networking: Detection Engineering, SIEM/XDR Tuning, Alert Triage, Active Directory, Linux, TCP/IP